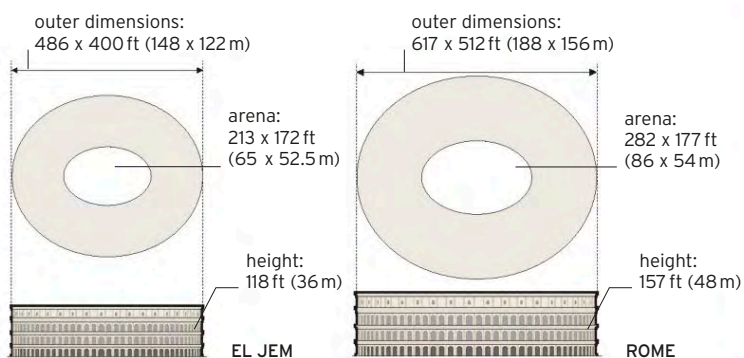


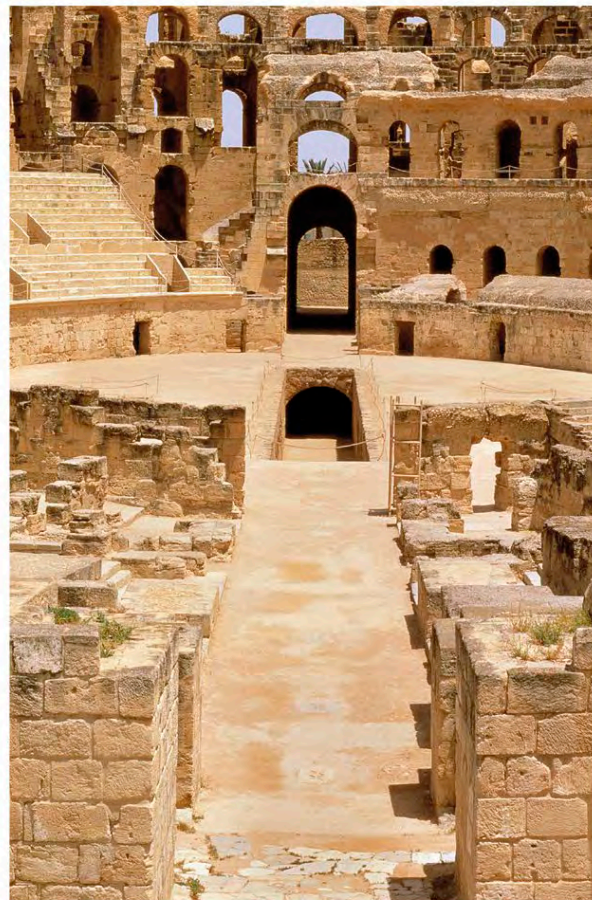


EL JEM AND THE COLOSSEUM

The amphitheater at El Jem was clearly modeled on the Flavian Colosseum in Rome and is only slightly less grand in scale. Both have three levels of Corinthian or composite arcades and similar tiered seating around the oval arena. A significant but less obvious difference is the less sophisticated complex of underground passageways in the El Jem amphitheater.



The amphitheater is the **third** to have been **built** at El Jem—ruins of an **earlier structure** can still be seen



△ SYMBOL OF AUTHORITY

The El Jem amphitheater, the third largest in the Roman Empire, was intended as a conspicuous symbol of Roman wealth and power in North Africa.

◁ RED LIMESTONE

The local limestone blocks used in the construction of the amphitheater remain well preserved thanks to the arid climate, but the building has suffered war damage and some looting.